

Chapter 112-1

Gu Xingyue had come out during a break between classes. She would have to go back soon to continue teaching the children.

Liang Shi didn't ask why she had suddenly been placed under Yang Jiani's strict supervision again recently. She only indirectly inquired about her current situation.

Gu Xingyue took a sip of tea and said faintly, "Not dead yet, so I suppose that counts as okay?"

That one sentence left Liang Shi speechless.

But after a moment, Liang Shi said very seriously, "Be a little kinder to yourself."

Gu Xingyue looked at her. "What's the use? Life hasn't treated me any better because of it."

"That's exactly why you need to be better to yourself." Liang Shi said, "I will help you escape from your current life, so you need to hold on."

When Liang Shi said this, her gaze was intense.

Gu Xingyue suddenly lowered her head and laughed at the sight.

There was some bitterness in that laugh.

"Why are you helping me?" Gu Xingyue asked. "Isn't it just to bring Qi Jiao's matter to light?"

"I can't deny that's part of the reason." Liang Shi didn't hide it. "But I think you shouldn't be anyone's stand-in."

Qi Jiao was Qi Jiao, and Gu Xingyue was Gu Xingyue.

When encountering such situations, Liang Shi's thinking was: help whenever you can.

Within the scope of what was possible.

What's more, Qi Jiao from childhood had been kind to her.

She also wanted to return this name to Qi Jiao.

Many things are done without reason, simply guided by emotion. In a daze, you look back and find you've already come so far.

Having already come this far, you can't just give up at a time like this.

Bad people should always receive punishment.

Liang Shi had once seen written on the title page of a book: "No man is an island."

If it were before, after investigating to this point, she might have given up. She wouldn't have been so determined to help Gu Xingyue escape this cage.

But after being here for over two months, her thinking had also changed.

She herself was no longer an island. Someone had barged into her life and brought her warmth she had never experienced before.

She had received so much, so she wanted to do what she could to bring Gu Xingyue out of her island as well.

Gu Xingyue treated people sincerely and was kind-hearted. Despite having experienced so much hardship, she ranked first as the most beloved teacher among the children at the kindergarten.

Children's eyes never lie.

What reason was there for such a person to remain imprisoned in a cage?

Liang Shi said sincerely, "You should have a better life—one that belongs to Gu Xingyue."

Rather than continuing to live under Qi Jiao's name.

Gu Xingyue's hands rested on her legs, her eyes downcast.

There was a gentle light flowing in her eyes. The shocking mark on her wrist revealed that she had just gone through a struggle not long ago.

This was a scene that occasionally appeared during her more than ten years of playing Qi Jiao.

She needed to show Gu Xingyue's rebellious edge on various major life decisions, using harm to her own body as a bargaining chip, in order to obtain a slightly more normal chance at life.

For example, when choosing a university, she wanted to stay in Haizhou City. Yang Jiani wanted her to choose oil painting because Qi Jiao had been talented in art.

But Gu Xingyue chose early childhood education. When Yang Jiani tried to change her application, she used this method to achieve a brief victory.

Another example was her job after graduation. Having grown up in an orphanage, she loved children and wanted to become a kindergarten teacher.

But Yang Jiani really wanted her to work at a library because Qi Jiao used to love reading and had said she thought being a librarian was the warmest profession in the world.

Gu Xingyue didn't agree. Instead, she fought against her once more, earning the opportunity to work at this kindergarten.

At all other times, she was Qi Jiao.

Quiet, docile, obedient—Qi Jiao without any thoughts of her own.

Qi Jiao who suppressed all her emotions deep in her heart, who didn't dare to get close to anyone.

Gu Xingyue had once been taught by the director: one must be independent and self-reliant, not depending on anyone else for survival. Don't be vulgar, don't be sharp. Be smooth when you can be smooth, and show your blade when you can't. You can't always be like fire, nor can you always be like water. Fire and water are incompatible, yet they must coexist.